WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

SAINT KITTS AND NEVIS

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Basseterre and Port Zante (St Kitts)	Capital, commercial centre and home of the Eastern Caribbean Central Bank; ground was broken in July 2026 on a new cruise terminal to support P&O Cruises home-porting from November 2027	Cruise tourism, port services, retail, financial services
Robert L. Bradshaw International Airport	Main air gateway, handling 41,490 airlift passengers in the first quarter of 2026 with nonstop links to North America; home-porting is expected to draw additional airline service	Aviation services, logistics, hospitality
South-East Peninsula / Christophe Harbour	St Kitts' premium resort and yachting district, where marina expansion is under way	Luxury hotels, branded residences, marine services
Hamilton geothermal field (Nevis)	Site of a planned 30 MW geothermal development to supply both islands; Iceland Drilling holds the turnkey contract for six wells, with drilling due in the second half of 2026	Geothermal energy, engineering, energy-intensive services
Charlestown and the Nevis financial services centre	Over 40 years of experience in international financial services, with sector revenue above EC$20 million for the first time in 2025	Trusts, limited partnerships, corporate services, gaming licensing
St Kitts solar and energy-transition programme	Solar procurement, including power purchase agreement preparation, is complete and bidding is expected, under the Sustainable Island State Agenda	Solar, battery storage, grid modernisation
Special Sustainability Zones (proposed)	Framework for large-scale integrated developments under the Special Sustainability Zones Authorisation Act 2025, with a first application (Destiny, Nevis) under independent review	Mixed-use development, tourism, infrastructure

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- St Kitts Investment Promotion Agency (SKIPA) and the Nevis Investment Promotion Agency provide facilitation and guidance on incentives, licences and approvals on each island
- Fiscal Incentives Act offering tax holidays and import-duty exemptions for qualifying manufacturing and export enterprises, in a jurisdiction with no personal income tax

- Special Sustainability Zones Authorisation Act 2025, setting statutory safeguards and an Independent Oversight Body for large-scale integrated investment zones
- Citizenship by Investment Programme, with a Sustainable Island State Contribution from $250,000 plus real estate and public-benefit options, now overseen by the regional Eastern Caribbean Citizenship by Investment Regulatory Authority
- Nevis international financial services regime, regulated by the Financial Services Regulatory Commission, covering trusts, limited partnerships and newly introduced gaming services
- Power purchase agreements with the utilities for solar and geothermal generation under the Sustainable Island State Agenda
- Eastern Caribbean dollar fixed at EC$2.70 to the US dollar under the Eastern Caribbean Central Bank, with no restrictions on repatriating profits, dividends or imported capital

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Saint Kitts and Nevis in October 2026 offers a stable, high-income and tourism-led economy, with GDP of around $1.1 billion and income per head of about $21,000. The IMF estimates growth of 1.5% in 2025 and projects 2.2% in 2026, rising to around 2.5% over the medium term, with inflation of 1.5% at end-2025. Tourism is performing strongly: stayover arrivals rose 6% to just under 170,000 in 2025, first-quarter 2026 airlift reached 41,490 passengers, and the 2025–26 cruise season passed 918,000 passengers, the highest since 2019. Foreign direct investment was 2.9% of GDP in 2025, taking the inward stock to about $1.7 billion. Public debt stood at 58.4% of GDP in 2025 and net international reserves at $269 million, equal to 4.3 months of imports. The government's Sustainable Island State Agenda, a new Port Zante cruise terminal, geothermal drilling on Nevis and a Sovereign Wealth and Resilience Fund bill give the investment story clear direction.

The country's main structural consideration is the transition of its public finances away from Citizenship by Investment revenue, which fell from almost 26% of GDP in 2022 to 5.3% in 2025. As a result, the fiscal deficit reached an estimated 11.7% of GDP in 2025 and the IMF projects debt rising to 64% of GDP in 2026, above the regional 60% benchmark. The authorities are responding on several fronts: fiscal consolidation, with the deficit projected to narrow to 8.2% of GDP in 2026; programme reforms including the new regional regulator, digital verification, an external audit of the Citizenship by Investment Unit and planned physical-presence requirements; and a Sovereign Wealth and Resilience Fund to ring-fence revenue for disaster recovery. Diversification is the opportunity: geothermal and solar power aim to lower energy costs and import dependence, while cruise home-porting, airlift growth and Nevis financial services widen the economic base.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Lower Citizenship by Investment revenue	Programme revenue fell from almost 26% of GDP in 2022 to 5.3% in 2025, widening the fiscal deficit to an estimated 11.7% of GDP	Consolidation and a resilience fund are under way; investors benefit from a policy push toward tourism, energy and financial-services diversification
Rising public debt	Debt of 58.4% of GDP in 2025 is projected by the IMF to reach 64% in 2026, above the 60% regional benchmark	The authorities are pursuing consolidation, creating scope for private and public-private financing of infrastructure and energy
International scrutiny of citizenship programmes	Saint Kitts and Nevis was named in a 2025 US review of Caribbean citizenship programmes but was not among the states placed under US visa restrictions in December 2025	Regional regulation, audits and planned residency rules strengthen programme integrity; investors should monitor US and EU policy developments
Banking-sector asset quality	The banking system's non-performing loan ratio was 15.8% in 2025, concentrated in the largest domestic bank, and the Development Bank needs recapitalisation	The IMF has recommended stronger provisioning and supervision; investors should work with well-capitalised banks and conduct standard counterparty diligence
Energy costs and import dependence	Electricity relies largely on imported fuel, raising costs for businesses and households	The 30 MW Nevis geothermal project and new solar procurement create direct investment and offtake opportunities

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Hurricane and climate exposure	As a small island state, the federation is exposed to hurricanes that can affect tourism and infrastructure	A Sovereign Wealth and Resilience Fund will ring-fence liquid assets for disaster recovery; resilient design and insurance should be standard in project planning
Small market and external deficit	A population of about 51,500 and a current account deficit of 14.6% of GDP in 2025 reflect high import needs	Access to CARICOM, the OECS and North American markets, plus cruise home-porting, lets investors scale beyond the domestic market

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Saint Kitts and Nevis combines political stability, a fixed US dollar peg for the Eastern Caribbean dollar, reserve cover of 4.3 months of imports and a tourism sector at or above pre-pandemic levels. Its central challenge is fiscal: replacing exceptional Citizenship by Investment revenue with sustainable sources while keeping debt near the 60% regional benchmark. The authorities have accepted this task openly, with consolidation measures, programme reforms under a regional regulator and a Sovereign Wealth and Resilience Fund. The country was not among the Caribbean states placed under US visa restrictions in December 2025, and continued programme reforms support that position. Investors should apply standard counterparty diligence in the banking sector and build hurricane resilience into project design, while the geothermal, solar and cruise home-porting programmes offer tangible entry points into the federation's diversification.

MARKET ACCESS

Saint Kitts and Nevis is a member of CARICOM, the Organisation of Eastern Caribbean States (OECS) Economic Union and the Eastern Caribbean Currency Union giving duty-free access to Caribbean markets and a shared currency and central bank. It is also a member of the WTO. Exports also benefit from duty-free entry to the United States under the Caribbean Basin Initiative and to Canada under CARIBCAN. The United States is the leading market for goods exports, notably electronic components, and the main source of imports. Air links to North America, the Eastern Caribbean Central Bank's headquarters in Basseterre and the planned cruise home port reinforce the federation's role as a regional gateway.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Dr Terrance Drew, also Minister of Finance)	Leads the Sustainable Island State Agenda, fiscal policy and Citizenship by Investment reform	Primary reference point for national strategy and major project approvals
St Kitts Investment Promotion Agency (SKIPA)	National investment promotion agency for St Kitts; advises on incentives and approvals	Standard first point of contact for market entry
Nevis Island Administration (Premier Mark Brantley) and Nevis Investment Promotion Agency	Leads Nevis-specific policy, including the geothermal project, financial services and the proposed Destiny zone	Essential partner for any Nevis-based investment
Eastern Caribbean Central Bank (headquartered in Basseterre)	Regional monetary authority maintaining the EC dollar peg, with reserve backing of 97.6% in July 2026	Relevant for currency, banking and financial-stability matters
Citizenship by Investment Unit	Administers the programme and its Sustainable Island State Contribution, real estate and public-benefit options	Key counterpart for approved real estate and development projects
Financial Services Regulatory Commission (Nevis Branch) and Nevis Finance	Regulates and markets the Nevis financial services centre, including trusts and limited partnerships	Relevant for financial-services structuring and licensing

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
NEVLEC and SKELEC (electricity utilities)	NEVLEC executes the Nevis geothermal project; SKELEC is the offtaker for St Kitts generation, including solar	Key counterparts for energy-sector investment and power purchase agreements

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The St Kitts-Nevis Chamber of Industry and Commerce is the principal private-sector body and is building links with partner chambers through investment summits. SKIPA and the Nevis Investment Promotion Agency provide on-island facilitation, while Nevis Finance markets the Nevis financial services centre at international events, including a conference in Vancouver in April 2026. The Caribbean Development Bank, the Inter-American Development Bank and the Green Climate Fund are financing partners in the geothermal programme, and the St. Christopher Air and Sea Ports Authority leads the Port Zante cruise terminal. The Eastern Caribbean Central Bank's presence in Basseterre also makes the capital a natural meeting point for regional finance.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Saint Kitts and Nevis best suits investors seeking a stable, US dollar-pegged Caribbean base with clear diversification opportunities: renewable-energy developers and engineering firms targeting geothermal, solar and storage under long-term power purchase agreements; luxury hospitality, marina and branded-residence developers drawn by strong tourism growth and cruise home-porting; financial-services and corporate-services firms using the Nevis regime; and infrastructure investors interested in port, airport and resilience projects. Real estate investors linked to the citizenship programme should align with the reformed, regionally regulated framework.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage SKIPA and the Nevis Investment Promotion Agency
Open early dialogue on Fiscal Incentives Act concessions, land approvals and sector priorities on the relevant island.

STEP 2: Position for energy-transition procurement
Track the Nevis geothermal drilling programme and the forthcoming St Kitts solar tender, and engage NEVLEC and SKELEC on offtake terms.

STEP 3: Align tourism projects with cruise home-porting
Assess hospitality, logistics and airlift-linked opportunities around the Port Zante terminal ahead of P&O Cruises home-porting from November 2027.

STEP 4: Follow fiscal and citizenship programme reforms
Monitor the Sovereign Wealth and Resilience Fund, residency requirements and the regional regulator's rules, which shape public investment and real estate demand.

STEP 5: Build resilience and counterparty diligence into planning
Use hurricane-resilient design and insurance, and select well-capitalised banking partners for project finance and operations.